cate anywhere since and that I had bought at the same time I had bought the papers.

Slowly I read the comics of both papers, while dipping the cookies in the hot chocolate and polishing off the entire half pound, and then drinking the unsopped-up remainder of the hot chocolate. (This goes a long way toward explaining my slow but steady rise in weight.)

I then gave Gertrude the comics, transferred to the living-room couch, and read all the war news and commentary in the rest of the papers.

All this worked best in the winter, when I would go out for the paper of a frosty evening and then be delighted to return to a warm apartment. Cole Porter's "You'd Be So Nice to Come Home to" was popular in the winter of 1942-43, and I would hum it as I was going for the papers and cookies, and look forward to returning to apartment and wife. To this day, when I sing that song (especially the line "Under stars chilled by the winter") I find myself back on Spruce Street, going for the papers, and then I remember what I call "my Saturday nights" and I ache with nostalgia.

I suppose they're not what the average person would think of as good "Saturday nights," but those were mine.

10

On June 10, 1943, Gertrude reached Toronto and sent me a postcard from there, as I had asked her to do. On June 15, she left and reentered the United States as a full-fledged immigrant entitled to begin to make moves toward American citizenship.

On June 18, she was back in New York and there I met her again. She had cut off much of her hair (to my slight distress—for I like long hair on a girl). She affected horror at the unexpected sight of my mustache, crowding into a comer with her hands over her eyes, but I jollied her into letting me leave it on for a while.

On June 20, I went back to Philadelphia with my immigrant wife, and on the twenty-seventh, I decided I'd had enough of my mustache, and while Gertrude was still asleep I shaved it off. She didn't notice it was gone until I pointed it out.

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